

“Copy Shop...” allows you to take printouts of the document under the scanner, making IrfanView function like a photocopying machine. “Batch Conversion/Rename...” allows one to convert multiple images to different formats, along with the ability to choose the output quality of the converted image. The renaming function is useful if you have folders of images or other content with the names all messed up.

As with other image editors, IrfanView allows you to crop, rotate, insert text into, resize, change aspect ratio of, set as wallpaper, convert to greyscale, and sharpen the image. There’s even a red-eye removal function. “Enhance Colors” under the Image menu allows one to change the contrast, do gamma correction, and change saturation, colour balance, and brightness. Under “Effects”, you get some basic Photoshop-like effects; if you find an effect that is not available here but is in Photoshop, you can download the plugin from the IrfanView home page (www.irfanview.com). Multimedia plugins, plugins for numerous unheard-of image formats like .ecw, .fpx, .lcr..., filters, and miscellaneous plugins for FTP, e-mail, JPEG-Transform, and more can be found at the homepage.

Like we said, unlike other image editors, IrfanView allows you to play audio and video files. Numerous audio and video formats like .mov, .wmv, mpeg, .ra, Ogg Vorbis, and Flash can be played.

If playing with colours interests you, try “Swap Colors” under the Image menu. Animated GIFs can be viewed and stopped in between; also, you can extract all the frames of the animation using **Options > Extract** all frames.

One can send the currently open image as an e-mail (using the e-mail plugin) without opening a browser or e-mail client. The JPG Lossless Operations plugin allows you to flip or rotate an image without losing image quality. “Capture/Screenshot” allows one to take a screenshot of either the whole desktop area, foreground window, or just the “client area” in the foreground window (with-